

it with family and friends. Stop feeling bad about how simple our vacations are and start celebrating that we can afford to get away!

Some days we love using social media and others we want to delete it off our phones forever. It's difficult to find the radical middle. But like anything, neither extreme is the best option.

Setting physical boundaries can be a good action step to resetting how we think about ourselves in relation to what we see online. Taking a thirty-day fast or leaving your phone in another room for two hours each evening can be helpful. But no matter how good you feel about your social media usage, you will always be triggered to buy on the apps because that's a primary feature of their design.

Because of that, we've designed our not-patented two-step process for limiting social-media-influenced impulse buys (skip right to step two if you're already in a store!).

Step one: If the store website or app has the capability, make a shopping list called Impulse Intervention (you can actually call it whatever you want—this is just our favorite).

Whenever you want to buy something, add it to the list. If there is no list option, then create a note on your phone or in a journal. This gives you an action to complete that gives instant gratification. We like adding it to a list instead of a cart because it keeps a barrier between you and buying. Stores remind you about forgotten items in your cart way more than on your lists, so putting it straight into your cart puts you at risk for an impulse checkout. Once it's on your list, wait at least forty-eight hours. Why forty-eight hours? If you bought something on Amazon Prime, it'd probably get delivered to you in about forty-eight hours, so if it works for Amazon, then we'll use it too. We've also seen people use one week, ten days, even a full month. We love the idea of scheduling a monthly shopping spree. You can choose one day each month to make all your impulse buys. That way you can see all the purchases you would've impulse bought individually in one cart and decide if that's how much you want to spend instead of finding out later that's how much you already spent. And if you truly want something, then you'll still want it in ten to thirty days, even if you miss a sale to do it. The number of items you'll pass up by saving and waiting to make a purchase will save you far more than any sale you'll miss out on!

Step two: If you're still thinking about this item forty-eight hours later, or you're already in the physical store, ask and answer these three questions